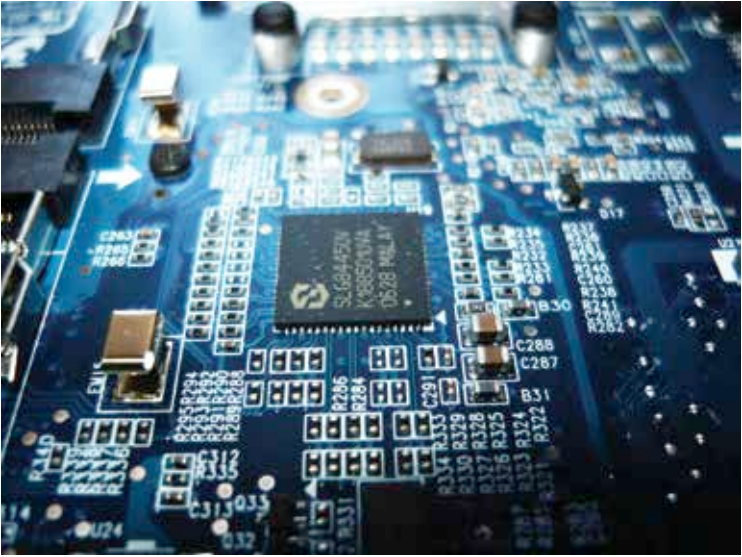




The world of maker tech can look more complicated than it is

replicated by anyone. It is usually a ‘hardware meets software’ approach to solve a problem that encourages reuse of designs, ideas and products, even in an exactly step-by-step identical way from websites, Maker magazines, and other resources. The few main segments in Maker tech are:-

- ♦ **Electronics** – Anything to do with circuits and semiconductors belongs in this one. From microcontrollers to sensors, this is the brain of maker tech.
- ♦ **Robotics** – Traditionally this would be defined as the mechanical side of Maker tech, roughly consisting of movable parts like motors, gears etc. But Robotics has become more like a combination of electronics, mechanics and computer science applied to create automated machines.
- ♦ **3D Printing** – If we compare the Maker movement to the Industrial revolution, 3D printing is the “power loom” for the “steam engine” of electronics. Making a prototype is not difficult at all anymore with printers available for as low as 100\$ (Peachy Printer on Kickstarter). The possibility to make a mould makes working with metals quite economical as well.
- ♦ **CNC Tools** – What can’t be done on a 3D printer, can be done by computerized numeric control, or CNC tools. With the aid of computer aided designs, modern cutting and shaping tools employ lasers, plasma torches,